

Words ending in -le, -el, -al, or -ol

THESE WORD ENDINGS ARE NOT USUALLY SUFFIXES.

Similar-sounding word endings like -le, -el, -al, and -ol can cause spelling difficulties. However, there are some guidelines that can help with using them. As with all tricky spellings, a dictionary is a valuable checking tool.

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Words ending in -le

The most common of these word endings is -le. This word ending is not a suffix because it does not change the meaning or part of speech of a root word. The -le word ending is usually found in nouns (such as *table*), verbs (such as *tickle*), and adjectives (such as *vile*).

edible

The letter *b* has a stick and comes before -le.

sample

The letter *p* has a tail and comes before -le.

wrinkle

The letter *k* has a stick and comes before -le.

dangle

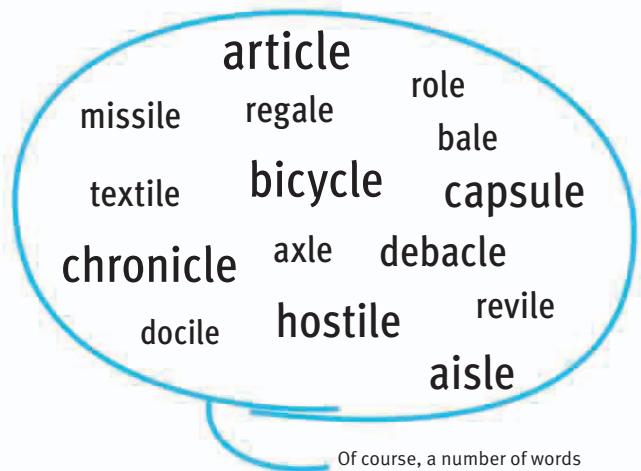
The letter *g* has a tail and comes before -le.

△ The rule

Words ending in -le are often preceded by a letter with a stick or tail—part of the letter reaching high, as in *b*, or low, as in *p*.



Some other **common words** that end with **-ol** use **oo** to create a long vowel sound, as in the words **cool**, **pool**, **school**, and **tool**.



Of course, a number of words that end with -le do not follow this rule. Some commonly used ones are listed here.

GLOSSARY

Adjective A word that describes a noun.

Noun A word that refers to a person, place, or thing.

Root The smallest part of a word without a prefix or suffix attached.

Suffix A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the word's meaning.

Verb A word that describes an action.

Vowel One of the five letters *a*, *e*, *i*, *o*, and *u*.